



30 Minutes Expert

Create Multiple Logins

If you share your computer with others, you can set up multiple user logins in Windows XP and Windows 2000. Setting up multiple logins allows each unique user to have his own tailored computing environment. Images and music are stored in personalised folders and, above all, you don't have to worry about other users of the same machine tampering with your content. Here's how to go about it.

Creating user accounts



STEP 1

Windows XP

Click on **Start > Control Panel > User Accounts**. Under 'Pick a task...', click **Create a New Account**. Enter the name for the account. Either a real name or an alias will do.

Pick an account type and click **Create Account**. You can create three types of user accounts: a **Computer Administrator** account where the user has unlimited access, allowing him or her to view and modify files from other user accounts. A **Limited** account gives the user access to operate the computer and run various applications, but not modify software and hardware contents. The last type of account offered in Windows XP is the **Guest** account. It



functions just like a Limited account except that it is not password protected.

Windows 2000

Right-click **My Computer** on the Desktop. Then click on **Manage**. Of course we are assuming that you have the administrative rights on your PC. (If Windows 2000 gives you a warning that you do not have enough privileges, contact the person who installed the operating system.) Then click on **Local User and Group** in the System Tools section. Double-click on **Users** fold-

er and right-click on the white space. Click on **New User** in the menu. Fill in the details and click on the **Create** button. Then click on **Close**. Select the newly formed user, click on **Properties** and then click on the **Member** tab. Click on the **Add** button and double-click on the type of rights you want to give to the new user. You can change the rights of the user at a later date by following the same procedure of selecting a user and then choosing the **Properties** option.

Changing your look



Windows XP

STEP 2

For each user that Windows XP creates, an image is randomly chosen for you and displayed on top of the Start menu. You can change it by clicking on an account to change under **User Accounts**. Select 'Change the picture' and choose one that you like. Browse for and change the desktop icons and views.

Windows 2000

Currently, Windows 2000 doesn't have the feature of your photo while logging in, so you can only make do with customising the desktop and Start menu settings. Right-click on the desktop and click on the **Appearance**, **Screensaver**, etc tab to select the settings you want. Each user can likewise maintain his own customised look.

Speed it up...20 min



STEP 3

Windows XP

Windows XP uses the **Fast User Switching** feature; you do not have to worry about shutting down the PC or closing all active tasks if someone needs urgent access to the computer. Enable **Fast User Switching** from **Settings > Control Panel > User Accounts** and tick the **Allow Fast User Switching** feature under **Change the way users log on** or off.

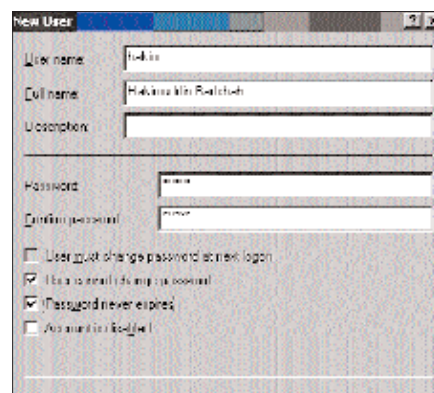
After that, in the Start menu select **Log off** and in the prompt select **Switch user** instead of **Log off**. Once you log back in

Multiple User Logins in Windows 98/Me

Windows 98/Me doesn't allow protection of files but you can still create multiple user profiles for customising and maintaining at user level Desktop folder, Documents menu, Start menu, Favorites folder, Downloaded Web pages and a separate My Documents folder.

To create User Profiles, you need to first have **Client for Microsoft Networking Installed**. For this, go to **Start > Control Panel > Network**, select the **Add Client** option and add **Client for Microsoft Networking**.

Restart your machine and then go to **Start > Control Panel > Users**. Follow the step-by-step wizard to create individual user profiles. Restart for the settings to take effect. At the login prompt now, you have to enter the username and password you have created for yourself.



under your profile, the system resumes with all processes and tasks, and applications pick up from where you left off.

Windows 2000

Unlike Windows XP, Windows 2000 doesn't allow 2 users to simultaneously log on. So, for another user to take over, the current user has to log off first. ■

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